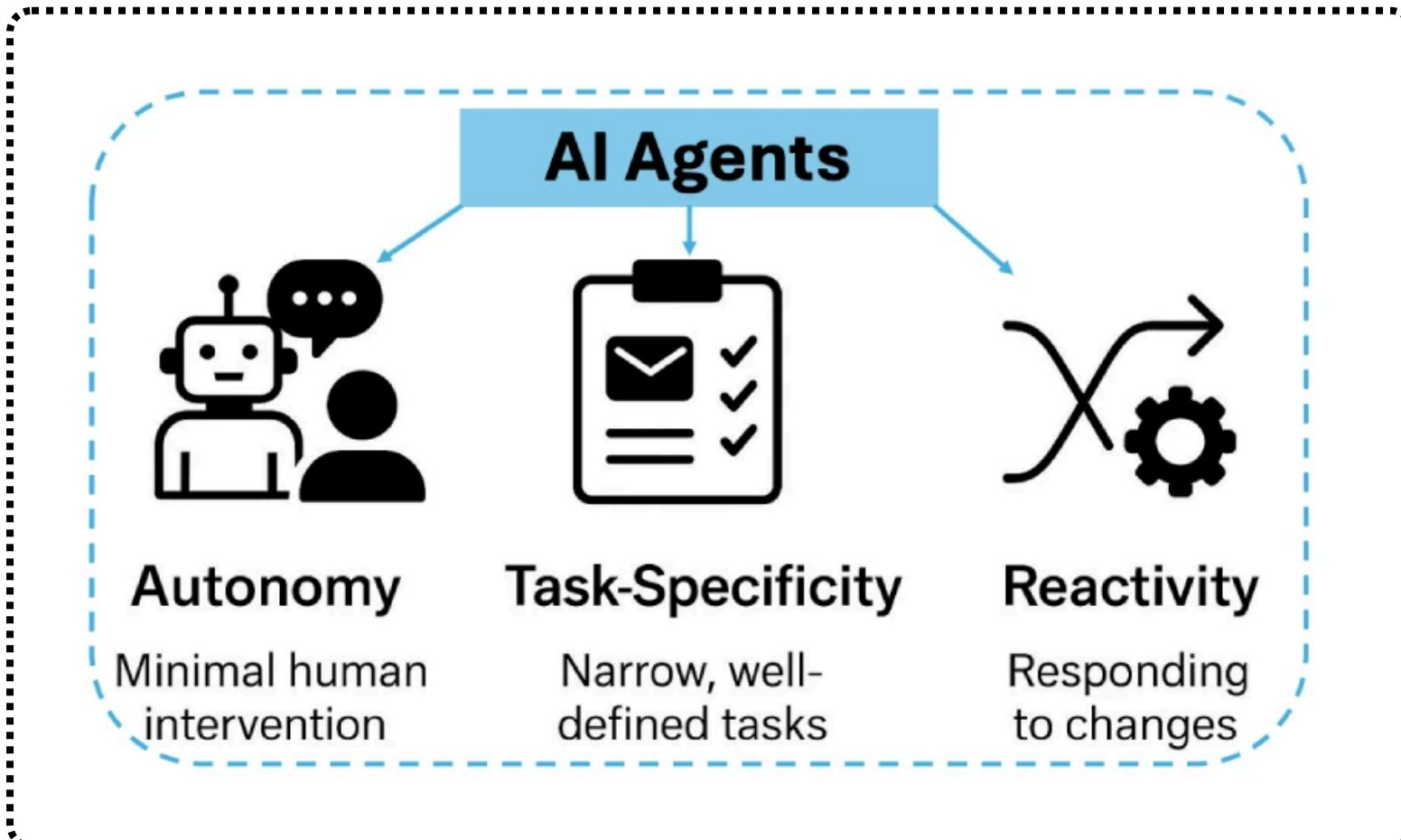
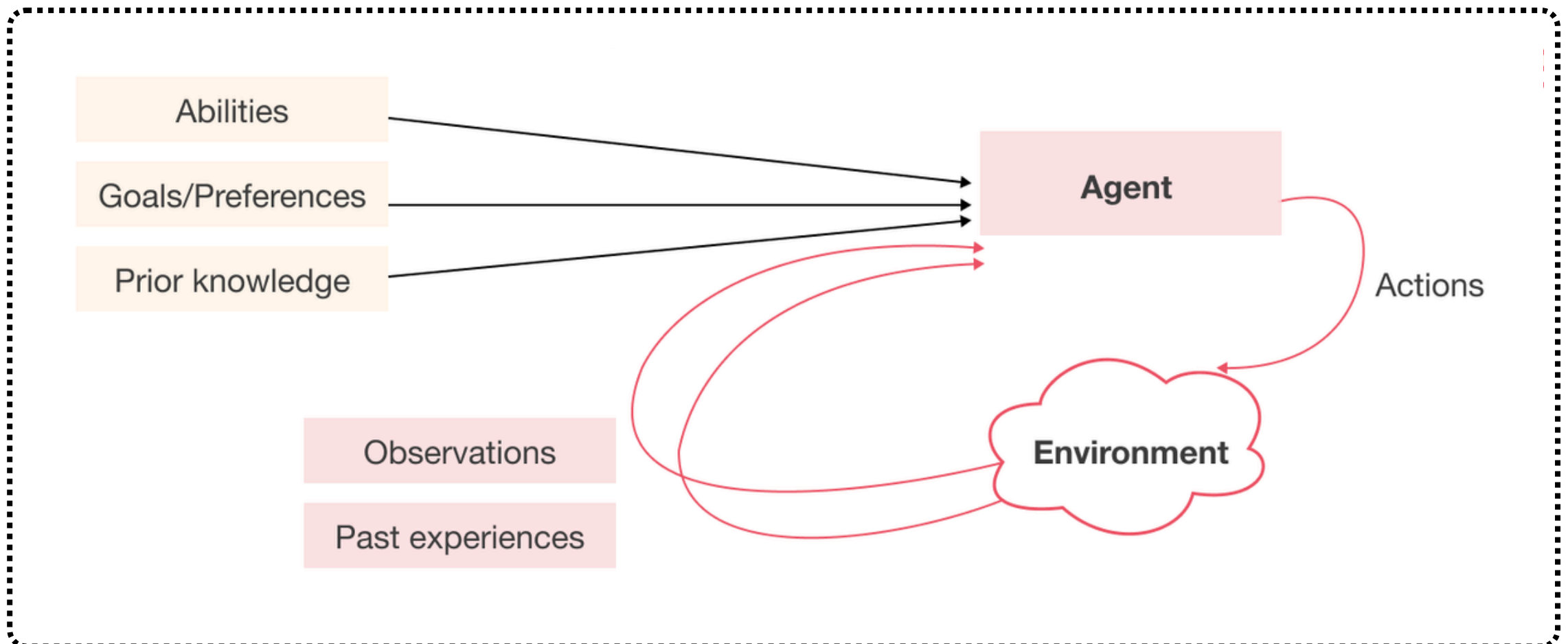


Key Characteristics of Agents



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Autonomy

The defining trait of an agent is its ability to make decisions with minimal oversight. Unlike traditional AI models that wait for explicit prompts, agents can set sub-goals, choose which tools to use, and adjust their path toward an outcome. Autonomy is what allows them to move from passive systems into active collaborators.

Memory

Agents need more than short-term context windows. They rely on memory to retain information across interactions which enables long-term planning, personalization, and continuity.

For instance, an agent assisting with project management can remember prior decisions, deadlines, and preferences, rather than starting from scratch each time.



To achieve this, agents often use vector databases such as Pinecone, Weaviate, and Qdrant. These systems store embeddings of past interactions or documents, allowing the agent to retrieve relevant context later. This retrieval-based memory gives agents the ability to “remember” user history and personalize responses over time.



Adaptability

Real-world environments change, and goals shift. Effective agents show adaptability dynamically adjusting to new conditions, errors, or unexpected feedback. Instead of failing when a plan doesn't work, they revise the plan and try alternate strategies. This adaptability makes them resilient and useful in unpredictable domains like research, operations, or customer service.

